

Account-Based Marketing: Setting the Table for Success

How Key Account and Strategic Account Managers Can Integrate Marketing for Customer-Centric Growth

Presenters : SAMA Academy faculty

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Session Description

Strategic and Key Account Managers (SAMs/KAMs) stand at a crossroads: they must deepen customer relationships while orchestrating internal alignment. One of the biggest challenges? Leveraging marketing without disrupting the trust they've built with clients.

"Your clients see you as their trusted orchestrator, the host of their journey. But bringing marketing's megaphone to this table works only if the message focuses on what matters to the customer. How do we create alignment without making it messier?"

SAMs/KAMs often struggle with marketing integration, asking:

- *"Why is Marketing here—they don't know my client as intimately as I do?"*
- *"Don't make the account messier with product-first noise!"*
- *"How does this help us both stay customer-centric?"*

When aligned correctly, marketing becomes a powerful amplifier of the right message, reinforcing trust and adding value rather than noise. This session will equip SAMs/KAMs with a strategic framework to harness Account-Based Marketing (ABM) for deeper engagement and sustainable growth.

Session Goals & Key Objectives

1. **Next Gen ABM**: What is it, what is the difference from what is currently acknowledged as ABM, and why should we care as a team.
2. **Customer Led, Team Enabled**: How to move away from a marketing led, sales enabled mindset to a customer-centric approach that is valuable to the customer. How do we go beyond collaboration of sales and marketing and truly integrate in a way our customers value.
3. **Small Steps; Big Wins**: The first steps and account plan integration. Clarify roles: SAMs as orchestrators, marketing as amplifiers.

4. **Opti- Channel Experience:** The value of Account-Based Marketing and the optimized experience. Use customer-centric tools like opti-channel approaches and measurable engagement strategies.

Key Discussion Pillars

1. **Marketing's "Megaphone": Enabling SAMs to Communicate Account Value**
 - Crafting customer-centric messaging that aligns with account objectives, not product push.
2. **Co-orchestration, Not Disruption: SAMs at the Forefront**
 - How marketing supports—rather than competes with—SAM-led strategy.
3. **Mapping the Account and Customer Journey with Precision Tools**
 - Using frameworks like COSA (Customer/Organization/Solution Alignment) to drive "outside-in" thinking.

Engagement Activities & Takeaways

💡 *The Customer Journey Map Exercise:* Participants will map out key account touchpoints and identify where marketing can add the most value.

👉 *Reflection Exercise:* "One Thing You Hope Marketing Solves for You" – SAMs will articulate their biggest marketing challenges.

📄 *Takeaway Toolkit:* ABM templates and integration frameworks for real-world application.

This interactive session ensures SAMs/KAMs leave with practical, actionable strategies to strengthen marketing collaboration and drive customer-centric success.

Audience:

- Center of Excellence leaders & SAM program
- SAM Leaders
- Business leaders
- KAM / SAM and KAM / SAM Managers